



Session Management Using PHP

Part 2: Server-side Sessions

The second part of the article explains the formation of sessions on the server side without the need to store any information on the client machine. This strategy provides better security for the session information and permits sessions to form even if cookies are disabled on the client applications.

Managing a session from the server side provides a safe mechanism to maintain the session. The session created using this technique can be spread across several pages loaded through many browsers (Firefox, Konqueror, Opera, or even IE). It means that the session does not expire even if one browser crashes and the same URL is loaded through another browser. Security settings of the client machine do not affect server-side session management.

For all these goodies, we have to spend time on a few extra lines of code

and provide one extra database table. A table called *session_log* is created in the *session* database, with columns for storing a session ID, user ID, IP address of the remote machine, status of the session (enumerated as VALID or EXPIRED, numeric values 1 or 2), start time and last-access time. Entries in the *session_log* table are made by the login script and updated by the status script.

The script for the display of the user name and password fields for login is given below (the script is saved in a file named *dbloginform.html*):